The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vanquishing Bandits

Āryacauravidhvaṃsananāmadhāraṇī · Toh 961 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མི་རྣོ་རམ་པར་འཇོམས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་འཕགས་དུས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vanquishing Bandits, known in Sanskrit as the Āryacauravidhvaṃsana Nāma Dhāraṇī, is a brief protective incantation whose Tibetan title is given in the text as an equivalent rendering of that name. The text opens as the Buddha sets out from Mount Videha with his attendant Ānanda, who catches sight of a large band of robbers in the distance and is struck with terror. The Blessed One calms him, telling him not to be afraid, and then speaks a dhāraṇī meant to utterly vanquish bandits and to shield those who recite it from the danger of thieves. It is Toh 961 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the short works of sacred formulas valued for protection and practical benefit.

In the language of India: ārya caura bidhvansana nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vanquishing Bandits.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was setting out from Mount Videha together with his attendant, the venerable Ānanda. The venerable Ānanda saw a great many bandits far off in the distance. When he saw them he was frightened, and his hair stood on end. He said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there are bandits! Sugata, there are bandits!"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, are you afraid of the bandits?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I am afraid. Sugata, I am afraid."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, do not be afraid of the bandits."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke this dhāraṇī, which utterly destroys the host of great delusion:

tadyathā anulome pratilome anuloma pratiloma ataṃke prataṃke paṃke atipaṃke gauri gandhari caṇḍali mataṃgi pūkkasi rimi rimi riddhimace baṣṭiti caurapradanhu bisthahantu bhamantu māmiyantu yabadgranthi na muñcami svāhā

"Ānanda, I have set a guard on every side for up to ten yojanas, and I have bound the feet of all bandits, of all the villagers in the mountain ravines, of all

who guard the hidden paths, and of all who intend harm. I have made them stupefied. I have made them rigid. Just as a potter's wheel is spun, just as a potter's wheel is turned round and round, so may the bandits tremble! May they be paralyzed! May their heads be bewildered! Until the knot is untied, may they not die!"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The rite is as follows. Mix asafoetida with donkey hair. Then recite the dhāraṇī twenty-one times over a thread spun by a pure girl. Alternatively, tie a knot in the hem of one's garment, and untie it once one has arrived safely. This brings success.

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vanquishing Bandits is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan for "Mount Videha" literally means "Body-Exalted Mountain." This is the Tibetan rendering of Videha, and it is probably the Vediyaka or Vaidehaka mountain near Rājagṛha.

The phrase rendered "all who guard the hidden paths" is uncertain. It may refer to watchmen or ambushers on narrow passes.

In the rite, the Tibetan may mean that the asafoetida and donkey hair are mixed into the thread as the girl spins it. The phrasing is compact and allows either reading.

In the closing line, the syllable "sho" is evidently a scribal slip for the usual final particle "so."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.